

# News Weekly

## "Tragic Avalanche Near Lake Tahoe Claims Eight Lives: Survivors Rescued via Emergency Beacons"

Eight skiers tragically lost their lives in an avalanche near Lake Tahoe, California, marking the deadliest avalanche in the state's modern history. Six members of their party survived by utilizing emergency beacons and the S.O.S. functions on their iPhones to reach out to rescuers. Among the survivors, two were hospitalized, with one continuing to receive treatment for non-life-threatening injuries. The recovery of the deceased remains unfeasible due to unsafe conditions and anticipated snowfall. This incident has sparked concerns regarding the group's decision to ski in light of avalanche warnings, as backcountry conditions can deteriorate rapidly. Sheriff Shannan Moon highlighted the allure of the backcountry while also emphasizing the inherent dangers associated with it. (New York Times)



## Tesla robotaxis involved in 14 crashes since launching in Austin, Texas, in 2025

Tesla's robotaxis have been involved in 14 crashes in Austin, Texas, since the service launched in the city last summer, according to data the electric vehicle automaker disclosed to federal safety regulators.

The five most recent incidents involving Tesla's self-driving taxis took place in December and January, according to a report posted by the National Highway Traffic Safety Administration (NHTSA). No injuries were reported, although the crashes resulted in some form of property damage in which the robotaxis collided either with another vehicle or a fixed object, the NHTSA data indicates. Two other incidents that occurred in July and October last year resulted in minor injuries. (CBS)



## "Consumption of sugary beverages is now associated with an increase in anxiety levels among teenagers."

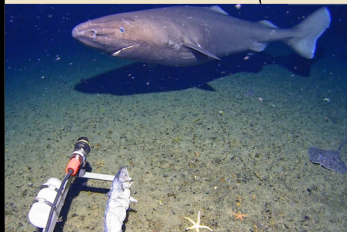
Sugary drinks may be linked to more than just physical health problems in teens. A new review of multiple studies found a consistent association between high consumption of beverages like soda, energy drinks, sweetened juices, and flavored milks and increased anxiety symptoms in adolescents. The review, which analyzed data from various countries, suggests that the high sugar and caffeine content in these drinks could be contributing factors. Excessive sugar intake is known to cause blood sugar spikes and crashes, potentially leading to mood swings and heightened anxiety. Additionally, caffeine, commonly found in many popular energy drinks, can exacerbate anxiety symptoms due to its stimulating effects on the nervous system. Researchers emphasize the importance of monitoring teens' dietary habits and encourage the consumption of healthier alternatives, such as water and herbal teas, to support both physical and mental well-being. (Source: Science Daily).



## Surprise shark caught on camera for first time in Antarctica's near-freezing deep

Researchers have captured extraordinary footage of a large sleeper shark, estimated to measure between 3 and 4 meters (10 to 13 feet), gracefully navigating the desolate seabed of Antarctica. Prior to this discovery, experts were under the impression that sharks could not thrive in these frigid waters. Recorded in January 2025 near the South Shetland Islands, this footage challenges the prevailing assumption regarding sharks' survival in such extreme conditions, as noted by researcher Alan Jamieson. This significant observation was made by the Minderoo-UWA Deep-Sea Research Centre, which specializes in exploring the ocean's deepest regions.

(Source: NPR)

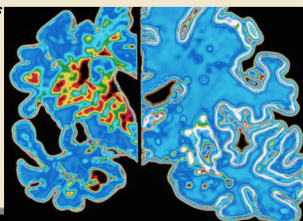


## Blood test holds promise for predicting when Alzheimer's symptoms will start

A simple blood test might one day serve as a molecular 'clock' that predicts not only whether someone will develop Alzheimer's disease — but when.

The test, published in *Nature Medicine* on 19 February<sup>1</sup>, is based on an abnormal form of a protein called tau that circulates in the blood, and begins to accumulate in the brains of people with Alzheimer's well before symptoms such as memory loss appear. If validated in larger studies, the test could provide a way to intervene in the neurodegenerative disease at an earlier stage, when treatment is more likely to be effective.

It could also provide a measurable biological marker, or 'biomarker', to make clinical trials of potential Alzheimer's disease treatments easier and cheaper. "Predicting if and when patients are likely to develop Alzheimer's symptoms could be useful in designing trials of interventions to prevent or delay symptom onset," says Howard Fink, a physician at the Minneapolis Veterans Affairs Health Care System in Minnesota. (Source: Science Daily)



# Olympic Leaderboard Rankings

| Order | NOC                      | G  | S  | B  |    |
|-------|--------------------------|----|----|----|----|
| 1     | Norway                   | 18 | 12 | 11 | 41 |
| 2     | United States of America | 12 | 12 | 9  | 33 |
| 3     | Netherlands              | 10 | 7  | 3  | 20 |
| 4     | Italy                    | 10 | 6  | 14 | 30 |
| 5     | Germany                  | 8  | 10 | 8  | 26 |
| 6     | France                   | 8  | 9  | 6  | 23 |
| 7     | Sweden                   | 8  | 6  | 4  | 18 |
| 8     | Switzerland              | 6  | 9  | 8  | 23 |
| 9     | Austria                  | 5  | 8  | 5  | 18 |
| 10    | Japan                    | 5  | 7  | 12 | 24 |

|   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
|   | 2 |   | 6 | 4 | 3 | 7 | 8 | 5 |
| 5 | 6 |   | 1 |   |   |   | 4 | 2 |
|   |   |   |   |   | 7 |   |   |   |
| 6 |   | 4 |   |   | 5 |   |   |   |
| 9 | 3 |   |   | 6 |   | 4 | 5 | 7 |
| 7 | 5 | 2 |   |   | 1 | 8 |   | 6 |
|   |   | 3 |   | 5 |   |   | 7 |   |
|   |   | 5 | 2 | 3 | 6 |   |   | 4 |
|   |   |   | 7 |   |   |   | 2 | 3 |

## King Cake

**\*Prepare the Dough:\***

1. **\*\*Scald milk:\*** Heat milk until steaming, then stir in melted butter; cool.

2. **\*\*Bloom yeast:\*** Mix warm water, yeast, and sugar; let foam.

3. **\*\*Combine:\*** Add cooled milk mixture, eggs, salt, nutmeg, and sugar to yeast; whisk.

4. **\*\*Add flour:\*** Incorporate flour gradually with a mixer until dough forms.

5. **\*\*Knead:\*** Knead on a floured surface until smooth (8–10 minutes).

6. **\*\*First Rise:\*** Place dough in oiled bowl, cover, and let rise until doubled (1.5 hours).

7. **\*\*Punch and Divide:\*** Punch down and divide dough into two halves.

**\*Form and Fill:\***

8. **\*\*Roll out:\*** Shape each half into a 10x16-inch rectangle.

9. **\*\*Make filling:\*** Mix brown sugar, pecans, flour, raisins, and cinnamon; add melted butter.

10. **\*\*Fill:\*** Sprinkle filling on dough and press down.

11. **\*\*Roll and shape:\*** Roll into logs and form oval rings.

12. **\*\*Prep for baking:\*** Place on parchment-lined sheet and cut at intervals.

13. **\*\*Second Rise:\*** Cover and let rise until doubled (30–45 minutes).

**\*Bake and Finish:\***

14. **\*\*Preheat oven:\*** Set to 375°F (190°C).

15. **\*\*Bake:\*** Bake until golden brown (about 25 minutes).

16. **\*\*Glaze:\*** Mix confectioners' sugar and water; spread over cakes.

17. **\*\*Decorate:\*** Sprinkle with sanding sugar if desired.

